

The cheat sheet

If you forget everything else, keep this. The biggest levers and the simple swaps, on a sheet for the fridge.

The biggest levers

- 1 Stop drinking your calories.** Cola, juice, sugary coffee, and the alcohol, especially kalimotxo and the sweet mixers. The fastest, biggest win there is.
- 2 Move every day, and not only walks.** A daily walk is gold (~7,000 steps, ~300 kcal), but add a little proper strength too. It protects your muscle, your back and your health, not just your calorie count.
- 3 Protein and vegetables first, every meal.** Half the plate vegetables, a palm of protein, then a smaller side of bread, rice or potato. Full on fewer calories.
- 4 Don't keep the trigger food in the house.** You beat the biscuits on Saturday in the shop, not at 10 p.m. on the couch. If it isn't there, you won't eat it.
- 5 Close the kitchen after dinner.** Last food about 3 to 4 hours before bed, then water or tea, brush your teeth, done.
- 6 Measure your fats.** Oil with a spoon or a spray, never a free pour. One tablespoon of olive oil is about 120 kcal.
- 7 Protect your sleep.** One bad night and your hunger hormones turn up the volume. Good sleep is a weight-loss tool.

Avoid this, do this instead

 Avoid this	 Do this instead
Cola, juice, energy drinks	Sparkling water with lemon; coffee or tea, no sugar
A free pour of oil into the pan	Measure it: one spoon, or a spray (1 tbsp ≈ 120 kcal)
A mountain of white bread or rice	Half a plate of vegetables first, a smaller side of carbs
Shopping hungry with no list	Eat first, shop the edges of the store, stick to the list
"Just one" from the big bag	Buy single-serve, and keep it out of the house

✗ Avoid this

✓ Do this instead

Snacking all day long

2 or 3 real meals; let the body burn its own fat between

Sausages, bacon, chorizo every day

Fish, eggs, chicken; cured meat as an occasional treat

The late-night cupboard hunt

Kitchen closed, water or tea, brush teeth, treat pre-decided

Sitting still all evening

A 10-minute walk after dinner

"I blew it, I'll start Monday"

Next meal, back to normal. One slip is not a collapse

Weighing daily and panicking

Weigh weekly at the same time, judge by the trend

Eating because you're stressed

Run the HALT check first, then walk, breathe, or call someone

HALT = before you eat, ask yourself: am I really **H**ungry, or just **A**ngry, **L**onely or **T**ired? If it is not real hunger, food will not fix it, so deal with the real thing instead.

What lands in the basket 🛒

✗ Leave it on the shelf (buy rarely, single-serve)



Sugary drinks



Sweets & pastries



Crisps & fried snacks



Cured meat, daily



White bread & sugary cereal



Ready meals & instant noodles

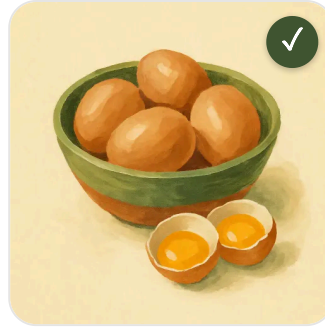
✓ Fill the cart with these



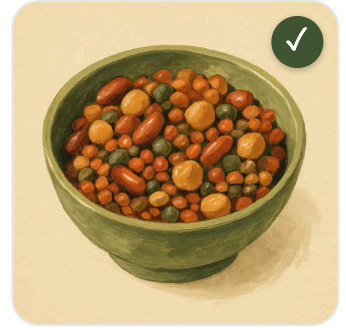
Vegetables & salad



Fish & seafood



Eggs



Beans & lentils



Fruit



Plain yogurt & nuts